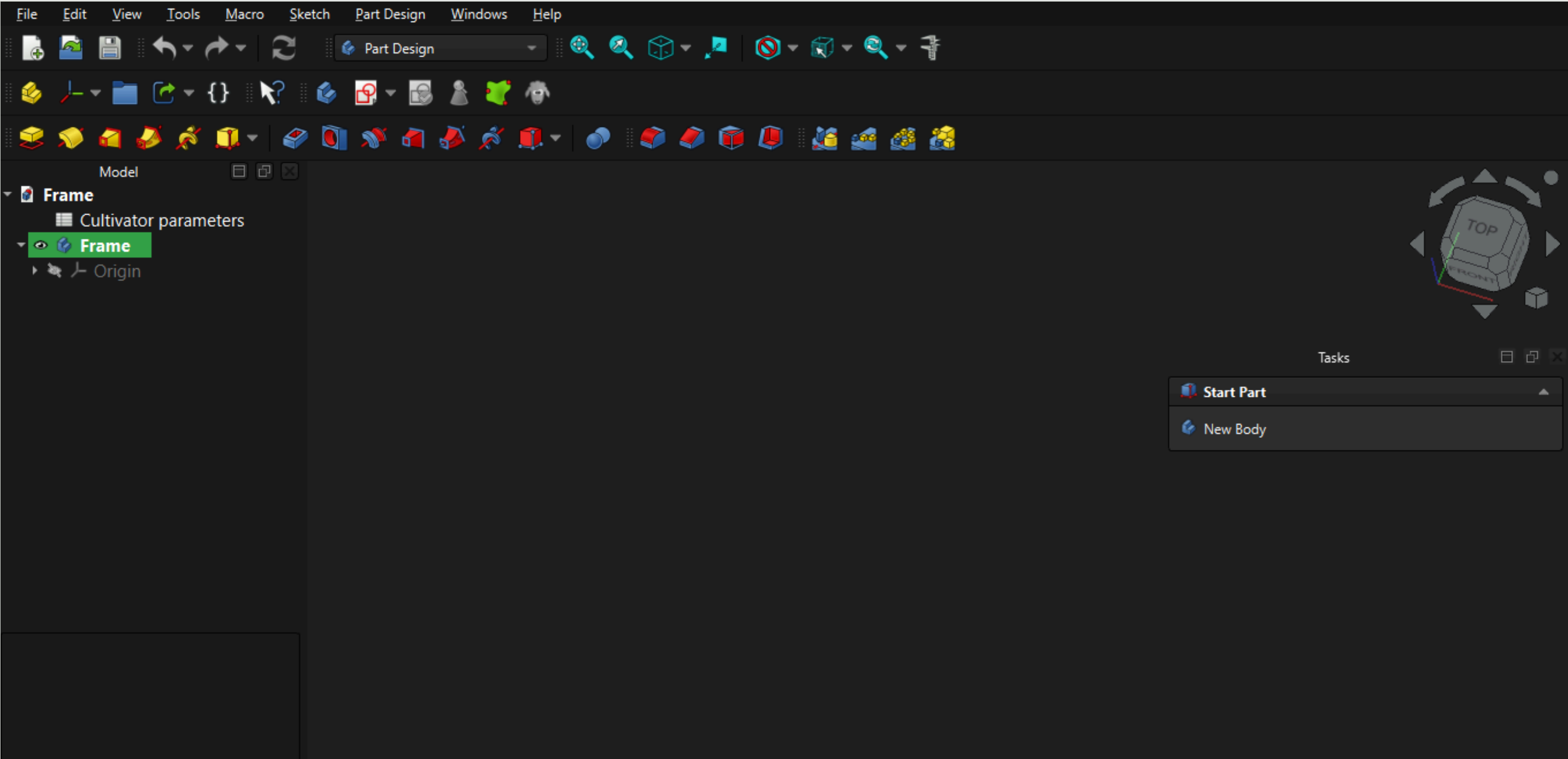


Setting Up a Part



Units first, before you draw

HOW TO CHANGE THEM

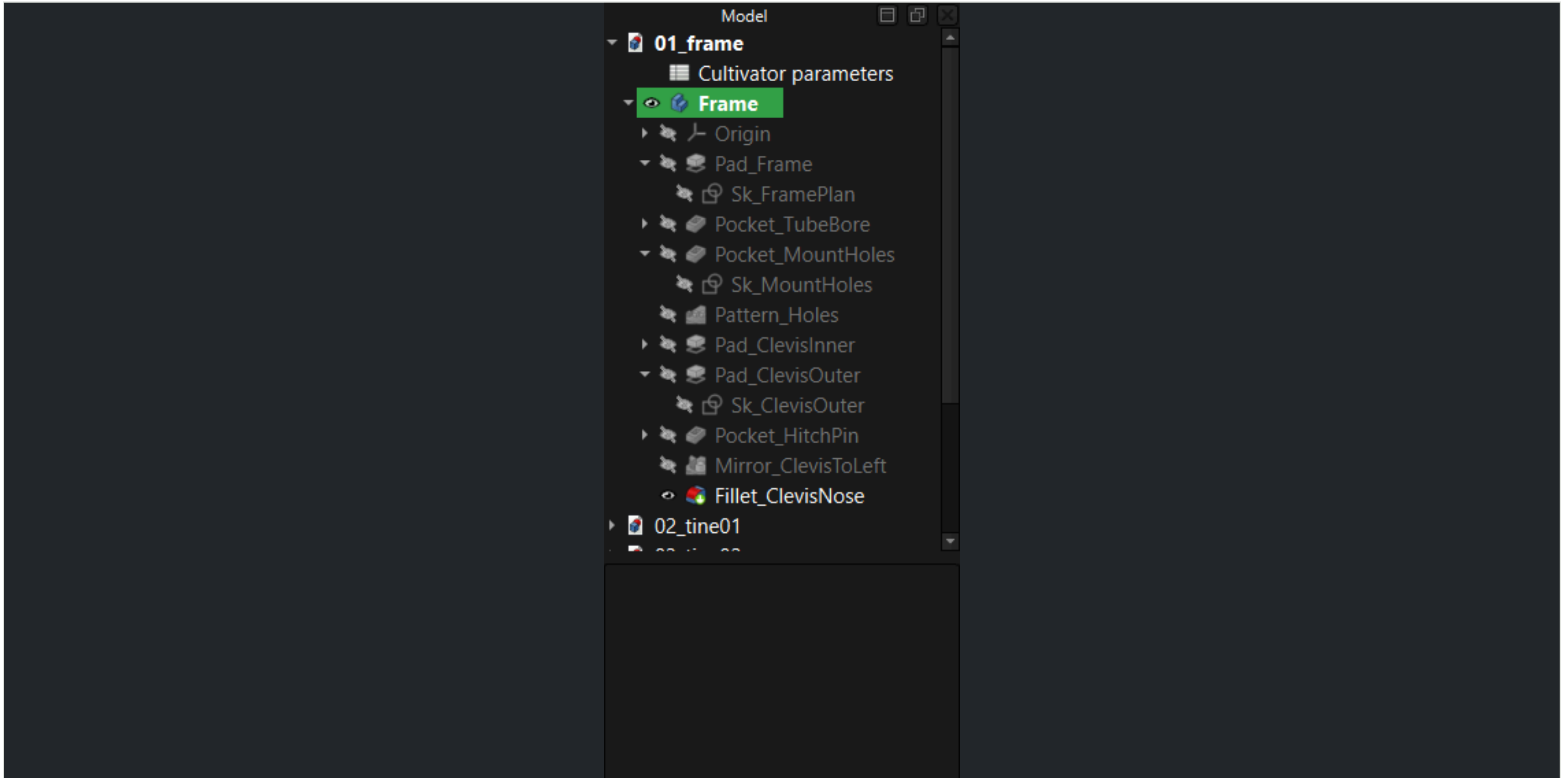
- 1 Open **Edit › Preferences › General › Units** —
- 2 Set the unit system to **Imperial decimal**
- 3 Set decimals to **3**
- 4 Click OK. Every box now reads inches.

The tutorial works in inches, so we work in inches.

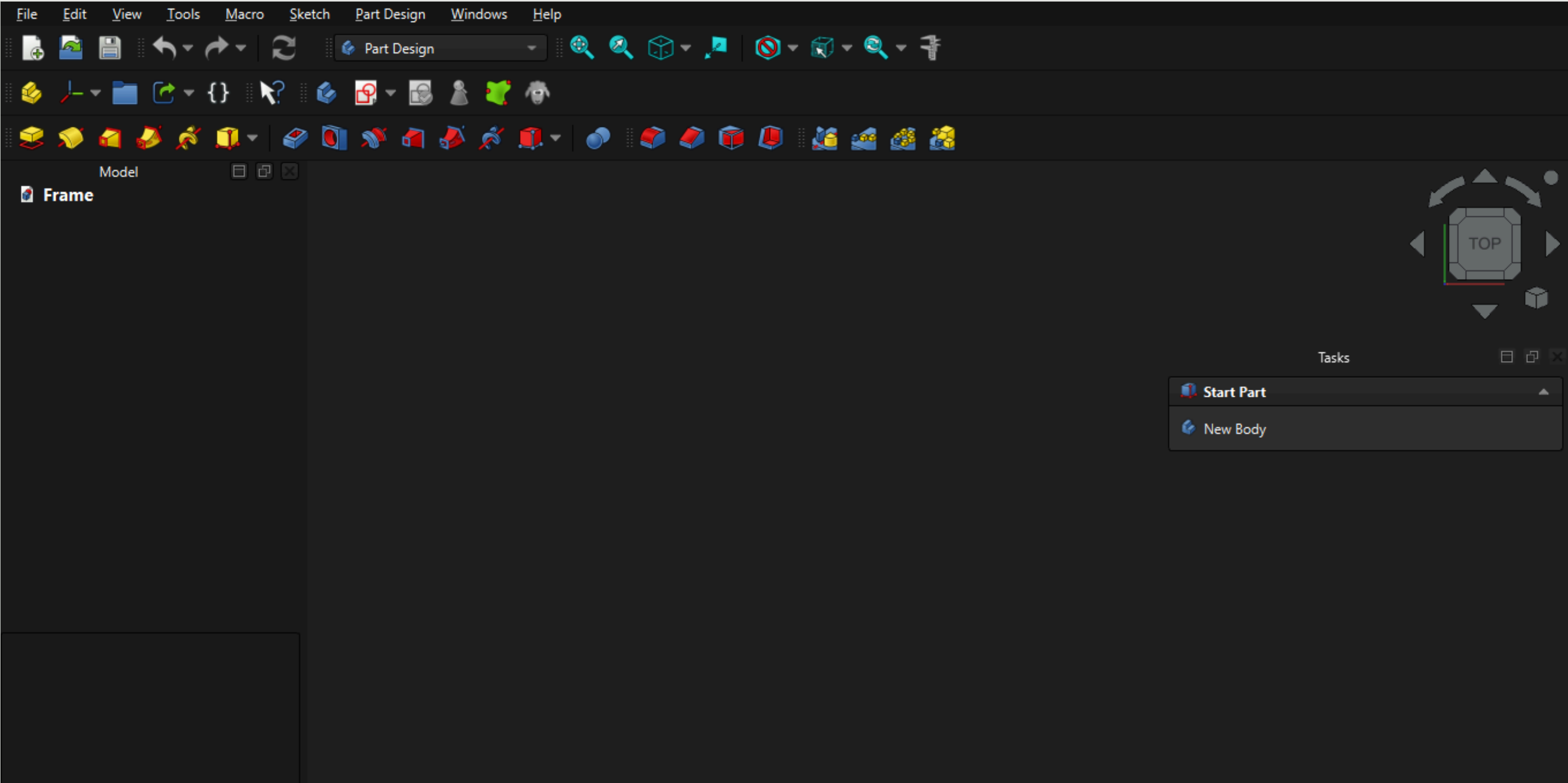
FreeCAD always stores lengths in millimetres inside the file.
Changing the units only changes what you see and type.
Your geometry does not move.

Do this **before** you draw anything. Changing units halfway through will not break the model, but every number you had in your head now reads differently.

Document, body, feature



Starting a new part



Which plane is which

FREECAD NAME	FACES	SOLIDWORKS CALLS IT	WE USE IT FOR
XY plane	up	Top	the frame seen from above, tyne heads, bolt holes
XZ plane	forward	Front	the blade section, clamp holes
YZ plane	sideways	Right	every side view: both tynes, both clamps

Every body starts with three planes. You draw your first sketch on one of them.

The names do not match SolidWorks. When the video says “select the Right plane”, you want **YZ**.

OUR MACHINE DIRECTIONS

- **X** runs across the machine
- **Y** runs front to back
- **Z** is up

Putting a sketch where you want it

